

Script · Stiftung Zurückgeben board

StoryMaps Berlin — *Verschwunden, nicht vergessen* · September 2026 · about 28 minutes, then discussion

DECK

b3rlin.storytimemaps.com/presentation/committee-2026

THE ONE SENTENCE

A research database becomes an interactive map, and the map becomes remembrance in the city.

BEFORE YOU START

Open the deck, accept the cookie banner once, press L for German, test →.

LEAVE WITH

A Träger, one dated introduction, one letter of support, plaque contacts, a sponsor for a pilot street.

OPENING · 3 MIN

Slide 1

homepage,
live

► Let the dots run for five seconds before you speak.

A year ago you funded this on paper. This is what it is now.

Ten thousand and twenty-one Jewish-owned businesses in Berlin, placed on the streets where they stood. Every dot is an address. Drag the year and you watch a city's economy flourish, come under pressure, and be erased.

The whole project in one sentence: a research database becomes an interactive map, and the map becomes remembrance in the city. Everything I show you today is one of those two moves.

Slide 2

the
foundation

First, where the data comes from, because in this room that question comes before any other.

The source is Christoph Kreutzmüller's *Ausverkauf* and the database of Jewish businesses at Humboldt University. The sixteen stories we tell in full come from Christine Fischer-Defoy and the Aktives Museum.

This year we checked every one of the 10,021 records against the source. 9,177 match on every field. The rest had 861 field differences: 607 we fixed automatically, spacing and diacritics. 254 are flagged for a human to look at. Nothing was guessed.

The whole interface exists in German, English and Yiddish.

Slide 3

the numbers

Three numbers to hold on to. 10,021 documented. 8,838 on the map at their real address. 9,679 closed between 1933 and 1945.

The gap between the first two is 1,183 businesses whose historical address we cannot resolve with confidence. They are not on the map. We would rather show fewer dots than a wrong one.

And behind every dot: a family, a livelihood, a place where Berlin bought its bread, its books, its winter coats. The map exists so that they are not reduced to a number.

Slide 4

the map,
live

This is the map itself. Let me show you 1933 to 1938.

- ▶ Click into the map. Drag the year slowly from 1933 to 1938.

Mint is open. Yellow is under pressure. Orange is closed. Watch the colour move through the city as the years pass. This is not an illustration; every change is a record.

- ▶ Click one cluster, open one business. Read its name and its dates aloud. Then click outside the map.

Anyone with a browser can do this. No login, no cost.

About 4 minutes. F for fullscreen, Esc back.

Slide 5

the tour,
live

Now the same city from street level. Fifteen storefronts, 1925 to 1945, the buildings raised to their 1930 height on today's ground.

- ▶ Click into the frame. Click the red markers on the timeline; each jumps to one store. Stop at station 3.

And this is what the site looks like today.

- ▶ Press the "Heute" toggle top-left. Let it sit. Show the Street View pane in the card.

Same camera, same corner, ninety years apart. That is the whole idea of the project in one screen.

About 3 minutes. Say as little as possible here.

Slide 6

archive,
street,
museum

Memory in three places. The archive, which you just saw, is online. The street: memorial plaques at the real addresses, in progress. The museum: a walk-on map and a touch kiosk, a working prototype.

They feed each other. A plaque carries a code that opens the map. The map leads into the exhibit. The exhibit sends you back out to the street.

And it travels. Frankfurt is our first city beyond Berlin. The method works anywhere there is a source like Berlin's.

Slides 7–8

E. Braun &
Co.

One address, so the numbers have a face.

E. Braun and Co., Unter den Linden, next to the Hotel Adlon. A Viennese house for fine linen and fashion. Käthe Dorsch and Paul Hindemith shopped here.

► Next slide.

Opened 1914. In 1933 the owners are spared, for a while, because they are Austrian. In 1938, after the Anschluss, Siegfried Oser-Braun is arrested on a business trip and forced to sell from his cell. In 1943 the store is closed as irrelevant to the war, seized, and then bombed. In 1954 the sale is declared void. Today the Hotel Adlon stands on the site.

Every dot has a story of this shape. For sixteen we have told it. For ten thousand we know the name, the trade, the address, the dates.

► If asked why the plaque says Nr. 75: that was the historical number; the block was renumbered.

Slide 9

plaques

From the map to the wall. This is what your grant paid for most directly.

Two formats. A large one with the story and an engraving of the storefront. A compact one with the four facts: name, trade, dates, place. If a record is missing any of the four, it gets no plaque. We do not guess.

Every plaque says what it is and what happened: a Jewish business, expropriated and liquidated under National Socialist rule. And every plaque carries the name Stiftung Zurückgeben.

Where we stand: eighteen plaques designed and verified, engraving files ready, prototypes made. None is on a wall yet. That is not a design problem. It is a permissions problem, and I will come back to it.

Slide 10

exhibit

The museum piece. On the left, the plan: a walk-on floor map, in three sizes because we do not yet know which venue will say yes. On the right, the kiosk.

The kiosk is not a rendering. The touch interface runs today, with an attract loop and automatic reset. It needs a room and a socket.

► If someone wants to see it live: press K, Appendix 1.

Slide 11

classrooms

For schools, two things, both free and online. Six lessons from one archive: single-period units with worksheets. And a workbook, “The street you walk on”: prepare, walk your own neighbourhood, document what you find.

What we do not have yet is a school that has tried it and told us what does not work in a real classroom.

Slide 12

what the
grant built

You funded three things. Here is where each one stands.

The complete digital project: delivered. Map, tour, kiosk, teaching material, three languages, all online and verified.

Plaque prototyping: delivered. Two formats, eighteen plaques with engraving files, prototypes made.

Three to six finished metal plaques: prototypes made, final fabrication waiting on sites. That is the honest status, and it is why the last part of today is the way it is.

All of this in four months, one developer, a hosting budget that sits near its cap.

Slide 13

next twelve
months

Four steps. Each one needs something we cannot supply ourselves.

This quarter: the first plaques go up, three to five addresses as a pilot. Needs owners, a district office, a workshop, a small installation budget.

Early next year: dedicated pages for museums and for teachers. Needs two conversations with venues and two with schools, so we build what is needed rather than what we assume.

Then the kiosk in a partner venue. Needs a room. Then Frankfurt complete and one more city begun. Needs a source and a local research partner.

To be clear: the pages are planned, not built. The kiosk exists; the venue does not.

Slide 14

funding

How we plan to pay for it. Six applications, one already out.

Bewegungsstiftung, thirteen thousand euros, both applications submitted, waiting for an answer. Hauptstadtkulturfonds, first of October, the big one, and open to individuals. LOTTO-Stiftung for 2027. The EVZ Bildungsagenda, sketch due first of November, larger sums, but organisations only. Prototype Fund if the framing holds. And a separate application to the Yiddish Book Center for the translation tool.

None of these is addressed to you. Two of them are why I need you, and that is the next slide but one.

► If asked about fees: project management sits inside each application as a personnel cost; there is no separate request.

Slide 15

team

Who is doing this. I build it: the map, the tour, the kiosk, the plaques, the material.

Chandra Brooks leads funding and project coordination: the applications, the partnerships, the day-to-day delivery. She is currently a guest researcher at the Royal College of Art.

And beneath us, the people whose work this stands on: Kreutzmüller, Fischer-Defoy and the Aktives Museum, Humboldt University, and you.

Slide 16

where we
need you

This is the real reason for today. Not money first. Ideas, and doors.

- ▶ Press 1. Read the yellow box. Stop. Wait. Then 2, 3, 4 the same way.

Museums and memorial sites: the single most useful introduction is a curator who will spend thirty minutes with the kiosk.

Schools: a history teacher who will tell us, honestly, what fails in the classroom.

Plaques: one property owner on Unter den Linden or Friedrichstraße who says yes.

Press, research, funding programmes: a programme officer who tells us which application not to write.

- ▶ Write every name down as it is said. Then: "Let me make this concrete."
-

Slide 17

five asks

Five things. In order of priority, and each one you can answer today.

One, a Träger. Does anyone here know a non-profit association or foundation that would act as the legal applicant, and at what overhead? Several of the funds on that list cannot accept an individual at all. This single answer decides which of those deadlines are real.

Two, one introduction by the first of November. Centrum Judaicum, Aktives Museum, or Mitte Museum. The EVZ sketch needs an organisational partner by that date. I am asking with a date because dated asks get answered.

Three, a letter. A written statement of support or data cooperation from Christoph Kreutzmüller or the Aktives Museum. It costs one phone call, and it carries more weight in an application than any description of the platform.

Four, contacts for the plaques. Property managers, district offices, anyone who has put a commemorative installation on a wall, and a fabricator. Wall plaques need the owner's consent and, in protected areas, heritage sign-off. It is slower than Stolpersteine. And until a fabricator has quoted, there is no per-site price to give you.

Five, money, in two parts so it can be answered. One street as a pilot, roughly ten plaques, sponsored by a named person or foundation. And a small unrestricted sum for coordination while the large applications are pending. I put both on this slide so that we do not have that conversation in the corridor afterwards.

- ▶ Say the fifth plainly. Then stop talking.

One commitment per person is enough. We confirm everything in writing within 48 hours.

- ▶ If asked for figures: the plaque price exists only after item four; the coordination sum is Chandra's to name.
-

Slide 18

close

- ▶ Stay on 17 for the discussion. Move to 18 only when leaving.

Thank you. The address on screen is the map; the code takes you there. These slides exist as a PDF and I will send them tonight, with the list of what each of you offered.

A1–A6 ▶ A1 the kiosk live · A2 Frankfurt, same method, different source · A3 anatomy of a plaque · A4
press K how to contribute without money · A5 the searchable data · A6 all numbers on one slide.

→ ← Space next / previous	L German / English	N notes (not when mirrored)
F fullscreen a live embed	1–4 open a card on slide 16	K appendix · Home / End